1984

The VHP launches a temple construction movement. On Oct. 7, a 'liberation' march reaches Ayodhya

Feb. 1986

Rajiv Gandhi govt unlocks gates; sessions judge allows Hindus to worship at the site. Babri Masjid Action Committee (BMAC) formed within a month

June 1989

At its Palampur session, the BJP supports the building of a temple at the Babri Masjid site

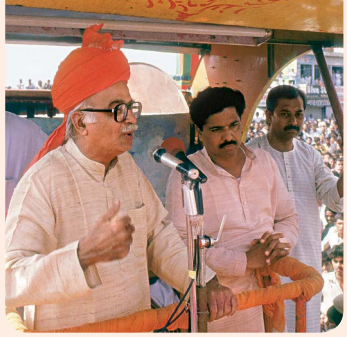
Aug. 1989

The Allahabad High Court orders status quo; all district court cases are transferred to it



Nov. 9, 1989

Rajiv Gandhi allows shilanyas at an "undisputed site" before the Lok Sabha election. Rioting follows. In the polls, the BJP tally rises from two to 86



Sept./Oct. 1990

BJP chief **L.K. Advani launches rath yatra**, arrested in Bihar. Kar sevaks gather in Ayodhya, 30 killed in police firing. PM V.P. Singh-led government falls

Jan. 1991

PM Chandra Shekhar initiates talks with VHP and BMAC

May/June 1991

The Ayodhya tussle is the core issue in the mid-term polls; BJP tally moves up from 86 to 119. It also wins the UP assembly poll

Oct. 1991

Kalyan Singh-led BJP regime in UP takes possession of 2.77 acres of land adjoining the disputed site, ostensibly for pilgrim facilities. BMAC challenges it

Aug. 1992

Kar sevaks lay a large foundation east of the Babri Masjid

Nov. 28, 1992

The Supreme Court (SC) accepts UP's plea to allow the singing of hymns at the site

Dec. 6, 1992

Kar sevaks **demolish Babri Masjid**. Rioting breaks out across the country, leaving 1,200 people dead

Jan. 1993

Centre acquires 67 acres around the disputed site, seeks to end all suits via the Ayodhya Act

Oct. 1994

SC upholds Ayodhya acquisition, rejects the termination of suits

Feb. 2001

At the Kumbh Mela, the VHP sets deadline to begin temple construction by March 2002

2002

Allahabad HC begins hearings to determine ownership. In 2003, it orders the ASI to excavate the site, which finds evidence of a structure predating the mosque

Sept. 30, 2010

The HC rules that all three parties—Hindus, Muslims and Nirmohi Akhara—are joint owners, allotting a one-third share to each

May 9, 2011

Supreme Court stays the HC's judgment



Mar. 2017

CJI J.S. Khehar suggests the three parties settle the matter out of court. Later that year, a three-judge bench led by CJI Dipak Misra takes up the dispute for hearings

Feb. 2019

CJI Ranjan Gogoi-led five-judge bench proposes a court-monitored mediation; after it fails, the SC recommences hearings in Aug.



Nov. 9, 2019

The court rules the temple will be built at the disputed site, government told to form a trust to oversee it; separate five acres of land to be given to Waqf Board to build a mosque

Feb. 2020

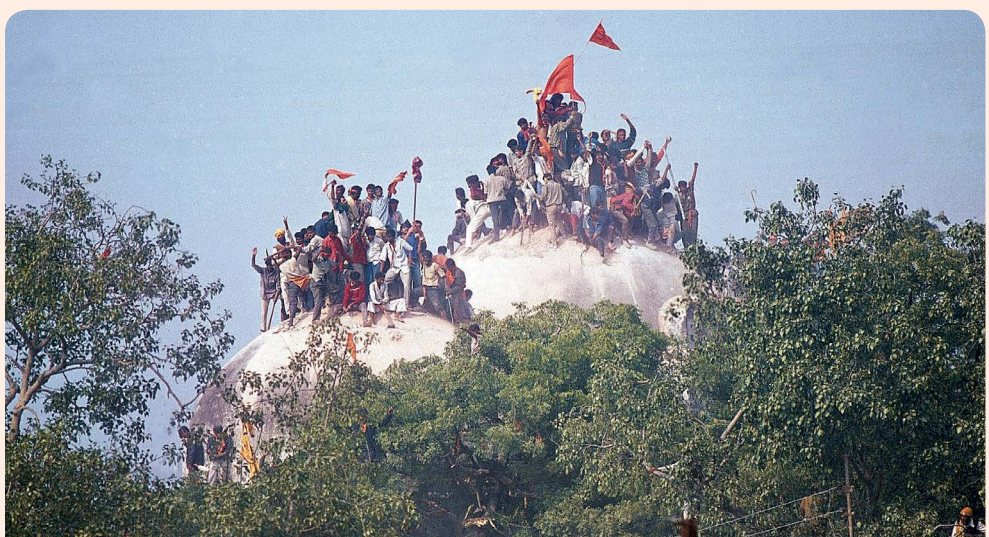
Prime Minister Narendra Modi announces a 15-member trust committee

Aug. 5, 2020

Modi attends the 'bhoomi pujan' ceremony of Ram temple; construction begins

Jan. 22, 2024

Modi leads the consecration of the **Balak Ram** idol in the partially built temple



PRASHANT PANJIAR

